

1. Who does the hiring, promoting, and firing of teachers in DepEd?

The hiring of teachers in DepEd–Surigao del Sur is a multi-level process. At the district level, the District Screening Committee (DSC), composed of principals and master teachers, observes demonstration teaching, assesses Teacher Reflection, and validates documents before submitting results to the Schools Division Office (SDO). The Human Resource Merit Promotion and Selection Board (HRMPSB) at the division level reviews and validates these results, ranks applicants in the Registry of Qualified Applicants (RQA), and the Schools Division Superintendent (SDS) issues appointments. Promotions through Enhanced Career Progression (ECP) follow the same process, while promotions through natural vacancy are handled directly by the division. The Schools Division Superintendent also has the authority to impose disciplinary actions, including suspension or dismissal, following Civil Service and DepEd rules. However, some of the cases are handled by the regional director.

2. Whom do teachers get instruction from in relation to their classroom duties and tasks?

Teachers primarily receive instructions from the school head or principal, who provides classroom policies, instructional directions, task assignments, and monitors teaching performance. Master teachers or head teachers offer technical guidance and mentoring, while department heads or grade-level coordinators assist in daily coordination, planning, and lesson implementation.

3. How do teachers describe their school as an organization in terms of decision-making?

Teachers of Sta. Juana Central Elementary School, Surigao del Sur Division describes their school in terms of decision-making as a participatory and collaborative organization. All teachers are involved in discussing and providing input on school policies, programs, and classroom-related decisions, which are deliberated and finalized during regular teachers' meetings. The Parent-Teacher Association (PTA) also participates in key decisions, ensuring both teachers' professional perspectives and parents' insights are considered. This shared responsibility fosters transparency, ownership, and cooperation.

4. What common issues of task delegation do they encounter?

5. Teachers often encounter issues such as unequal distribution of tasks, unclear instructions, lack of follow-up, hesitation to accept responsibilities, time constraints, and inadequate support or resources. These challenges can lead to confusion, delays, or overburdening some teachers while others have lighter workloads.

6. What actions can they recommend to create a better organization?

To improve organization, teachers recommend clarifying roles and responsibilities, encouraging feedback, implementing fair task delegation, monitoring and following up on tasks, providing training and resources, and promoting teamwork and collaboration. Assigning tasks according to strengths, offering mentoring, ensuring materials are available, and encouraging peer support help streamline operations and foster a more efficient and cooperative school environment.

Interviewer Insights:

Based on the interview, it is evident that the organizational structure of Sta. Juana Central Elementary School significantly influences teachers' performance in the classroom through the Basic Underlying Assumptions or the Deep Level of the Organizational Culture. Three major points emerged from the discussion. First, centralization in decision-making enhances ownership and accountability where teachers reported that being actively involved in school decision-making, together with colleagues and the PTA, fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility. When teachers have a voice in policies, programs, and classroom-related decisions, they are more motivated to implement school initiatives effectively and align their classroom practices with agreed-upon goals.

Second, clear task delegation supports efficiency and reduces confusion. The formalization of structure, with defined roles and responsibilities and the presence of the District Screening Committee and HRMPSB, ensures that tasks and expectations are clearly communicated. Teachers are more able to focus on their instructional duties when they understand their responsibilities, receive guidance from school heads or master teachers, and have access to necessary resources. On the other hand, unclear delegation or uneven workload can hinder performance, showing the critical role of structured task assignment.

Third, the five prime mechanisms support strengthening teaching effectiveness. The school's emphasis on collaboration through teachers' meetings, mentoring from master teachers, and coordination with department heads creates a support system for teachers. This shared responsibility, coupled with constructive feedback and peer support, allows teachers to refine their strategies, address challenges promptly, and maintain high-quality classroom instruction.

The school's organizational structure, which emphasizes participation, clear delegation, and collaboration, positively influences teachers' classroom performance by promoting motivation, clarity of tasks, and a supportive teaching environment. This insight underscores the importance of maintaining transparent, inclusive, and well-structured organizational practices in schools to enhance overall teaching effectiveness.